

# Today's work — design tokens + components

Dyuthi • 2026-08-31 • written in my own words, not a formal report

Had 4 things to get done today, so here's what I actually did, in my own words, not office-speak.

## 1. Picked 8 colours and wrote them into the code

Didn't want anyone (including me) arguing about colours later, so I just picked 8 and locked them in: the page background, the card background, borders, normal text, faded text, my main brand colour, a green for “approve”, and a red for “danger.” That's genuinely all 8. Nothing fancier.

## 2. Picked 5 text sizes, that's it

12px for tiny stuff like timestamps, 14px for normal text and buttons, 16px for card titles, 20px for section headers, 28px for page titles. Five sizes, done.

## 3. Left spacing alone

Turned out the app already measured everything in steps of 4 pixels anyway, so instead of changing anything I just wrote that down as the official rule.

## 4. Built exactly 4 reusable pieces, and stopped myself there

- A **Card** — the box shape everything sits inside
- A **Chip** — the small labeled pill (match score, why-matched tags, warning flags)
- A **Button** — one file that handles all 4 button styles (normal, approve, cancel, dangerous)
- An **Empty State** — the “nothing here yet” screen

I really wanted to build a couple more while I was in there, but I made myself stop. Rule I set: only build something new the second time I actually need it, not the first.

## 5. Actually checked if the colours were readable

Not just eyeballing it — ran the real readability math on every text-on-colour combo. And it caught something real: white text on my “approve” green button was basically unreadable (2.54, when it needs to be at least 4.5 to pass). So I made the green darker until it actually passed — 5.48. Glad I checked instead of assuming it was fine.

## 6. Made sure it's real, not just pretty

“Done” for today meant it had to actually work in the real app, not just look nice somewhere isolated. So I:

- Swapped the real Approvals screen over to use these new pieces — not a copy off to the side
- Opened the actual running app and clicked around to make sure it still worked
- Ran the type-checker — zero errors
- Ran all 236 automatic tests — every single one passed, nothing else broke
- Saved it and pushed it to GitHub, so it's not just sitting on my laptop

That's the whole thing. Small, boring decisions, made once, written down, actually working in the app — not just talked about.